Zino Aviation — illustrative high-growth scenario

Illustrative high-growth scenario — synthetic evidence. Not the company's actual performance. Every figure below is invented for illustration. The company's real Capital Q assessment is separate and is computed only from its own evidence.

Scenario illustrative-high-growth-v1 · Unicorn Potential method unicorn-potential.v1.0.0 (input rules unicorn-potential-inputs.v4) · Investability method investiq/v2+investability-inputs.v3 · engine unchanged · clock 2026-10-18T00:00:00.000Z

Result on synthetic evidence

Unicorn Potential: 75/100 · STRONG_SIGNALS · confidence LOW · coverage 95.5% · stage band SERIES_A_GROWTH

Investability (reported separately): 58/100 · INVESTABLE · confidence LOW · provisional · 3/48 criteria, 0/8 areas.

Stage. Established services business, not a pre-seed technology start-up: trading since 2018 and a UK company since 2020-12-24, with no venture round. The engine's stage bands are funding rounds, so the scenario uses the 'growth' band (SERIES_A_GROWTH), whose weights stress traction, unit economics and operating leverage (P4 16, P5 12, P11 9) over founder and market narrative. Scoring a mature operator as pre-seed would overweight its founder story. The business is capital-intensive at the Academy (an owned Lagos 737NG simulator, partly financed by an asset-backed facility) and asset-light at Jet (advisory and brokerage, no owned aircraft).

Scenario assumptions

Zino Aviation earns fees and commissions from two divisions. The Academy sells Lagos simulator sessions, ground school, pilot placement and cadet programme management, and earns a fee (not the full tuition) on partner flight-school programmes. Jet earns aircraft charter and acquisition brokerage commissions and advisory fees. The scenario reports in USD (naira receipts converted at each month's average rate) and measures to 30 September 2026.

Revenue FY2025 (Jan to Dec 2025)	USD 1.62 million
Revenue Q3 2025 / Q3 2026	USD 430,000 / USD 610,000 (+42% year on year)
Q3 2026 mix	Academy USD 420,000; Jet USD 190,000 (fees and commissions only)
Contribution margin Q3 2026	46% (USD 280,600 on USD 610,000)
Repeat purchase revenue Q3 2026	USD 268,000 (44% of revenue); 7 of 8 programme clients renewed for 2026
Blended CAC / payback	USD 1,500 per account / 2.5 months
Cash / net outflow / runway	USD 650,000 / USD 25,000 per month incl. simulator capex / 26 months
Bottom-up accessible market (Academy)	9,000 pilots x USD 9,500 per year = about USD 85M per year

Why the score stops at 75

- Every synthetic source is USER_CLAIM with evidence status SELF_REPORTED, the most conservative status the rubric still grades (reliability 0.5).
- The engine caps any source at reliability 0.5 or below at grade 3, and grade 4 additionally needs reliability 0.85 or more (MULTI_SOURCE_SUPPORTED, EXTERNALLY_VERIFIED or PLATFORM_VERIFIED) plus sustained, dated execution. Structured metric rules never exceed 3.

- This scenario never claims verification or independent corroboration, so every graded criterion is at most 3 and the overall score is at most 25 × 3 = 75. A score of 90 or more is not legitimately reachable on synthetic evidence; reaching it would need corroborated or verified real evidence across most pillars.
- DOCUMENT_SUPPORTED (0.7) would not change the score, only confidence; it was not used because no supporting document exists for a synthetic figure.
- Confidence follows source reliability, not the score: with every source at 0.5 the confidence index equals 0.5 × coverage, so it reads MODERATE only when all 24 criteria are graded and LOW otherwise.

The 24 criteria

Criterion	Synthetic evidence (self-reported)	State	Grade
P1.A Relevant founder expertise	Founder and CEO has 8 years of experience as a licensed commercial and offshore helicopter pilot and domain expertise in West African pilot careers; he has led the business since 2018.	OBSERVED	3
P1.B Adaptability and founder execution	The founder changed the Academy offer in response to customer feedback in 2025, adding employment bootcamps, and delivered the Ghana cadet intake milestone in May 2026.	OBSERVED	3
P2.A Accessible market demand	Bottom-up accessible market sized from customer spending of USD 9,500 per pilot per year on type-rating preparation, recurrent simulator time and placement (Q3 2026 average of paying pilots) across about 9,000 licensed and cadet pilots in Nigeria and West Africa, or about USD 85 million per year for the Academy alone.	OBSERVED	3
P2.B Credible expansion path	Expansion into Ghana: 4 Accra charter operators and 120 Ghanaian cadets became paying customers between April 2026 and September 2026 under a signed distribution agreement with an Accra school partner.	OBSERVED	3
P3.A Problem severity and willingness to pay	Paying customers cite one problem: licensed West African pilots lack type-rating preparation and recurrent simulator time near home; 1,140 paying customers bought Lagos simulator, ground school or placement services in Q3 2026.	OBSERVED	3
P3.B Repeated adoption or stage-appropriate tests	Retained customers: 7 of the 8 airline and government programme clients from 2025 renewed for 2026, and repeat purchases were 44% of Q3 2026 revenue.	OBSERVED	3
P4.A Dated growth velocity	Revenue grew 42% year on year in 2026: USD 430,000 in Q3 2025 (July 2025 to September 2025) to USD 610,000 in Q3 2026 (July 2026 to September 2026).	OBSERVED	3
P4.B Retention-supported traction	Repeat purchase revenue of USD 268,000 in Q3 2026 (July 2026 to September 2026) came from returning airline, operator and simulator customers, 44% of revenue.	OBSERVED	3
P5.A Contribution economics and pricing	Positive contribution margin of 46% measured on Q3 2026 actual revenue of USD 610,000 after instructor, simulator operating, partner and broker costs of USD 329,400.	OBSERVED	3
P5.B Sustainable acquisition and monetization	Acquisition payback measured at 2.5 months for corporate and cadet accounts won in Q2 2026 and Q3 2026: blended CAC of USD 1,500 against USD 600 monthly contribution per account.	OBSERVED	3
P6.A Differentiated assets	Proprietary dataset deployed in placement: assessment records of 3,800 West African pilots and cadets, used by customers (partner airlines and operators) to shortlist candidates since 2024.	OBSERVED	3
P6.B Independent defensibility test	(none: left ungraded)	UNKNOWN	—
P7.A Repeatable acquisition channels	Partner sales channel through flight schools and airlines is repeatable: it produced 38% of revenue in Q3 2026 and 36% in Q3 2025.	OBSERVED	3
P7.B Organic pull or channel efficiency	Referrals measured: returning customers and alumni referred 31% of new paying customers between April 2026 and September 2026.	OBSERVED	3

Criterion	Synthetic evidence (self-reported)	State	Grade
P8.A Runway and capital access	Current runway is 26 months at September 2026 net cash outflow of USD 25,000 per month including simulator capital expenditure, from cash of USD 650,000 held on 30 September 2026.	OBSERVED	3
P8.B Relevant investor or strategic support	Strategic support executed in June 2026: a USD 1.2 million asset-backed facility from a Lagos bank for simulator equipment, with an active agreement for a regional airline to send its first officers for recurrent simulator checks.	OBSERVED	3
P9.A Critical function coverage	Technical, commercial and operational functions are covered: a head of instruction with 6 type-rated instructors and 2 simulator engineers, a commercial director for Academy and Jet, and an operations manager who runs scheduling, visas and welfare.	OBSERVED	3
P9.B Time-bound delivery	Operating milestones for 2026 were delivered on time: simulator recertification in March 2026, the Ghana cadet intake in May 2026 and the Jet advisory desk in September 2026.	OBSERVED	3
P10.A Structural demand or technology shift	Structural demand documented: West African airlines added aircraft and routes in 2024 and 2025, and every airline pilot needs a type rating and recurrent simulator checks under civil aviation rules.	OBSERVED	3
P10.B Ability to exploit the window	The market window is being used: Zino Aviation is deployed with 1,140 paying customers and 9 airline and operator clients in Nigeria and Ghana as of September 2026.	OBSERVED	3
P11.A Growth decoupled from costs	Revenue growth exceeds cost growth in actual 2026 results: Q3 2026 revenue rose 42% over Q3 2025 while total operating costs rose 24%.	OBSERVED	3
P11.B Repeatable deployment	Repeat deployments completed in 2026: the cadet logistics programme ran for two airlines and one state government in Nigeria and went live in Ghana in May 2026.	OBSERVED	3
P12.A Ecosystem access and partnerships	Ecosystem partnership active since 2024 with two approved partner flight schools in South Africa and Greece, which delivered 64 cadet places in 2026.	OBSERVED	3
P12.B Strategic adjacent opportunities	Strategic opportunity in cadet financing has an executed agreement: a Lagos bank and Zino Aviation launched a cadet loan product in August 2026 with 40 approved cadets.	OBSERVED	3

Criteria left ungraded

- **P6.B**: Independent defensibility test: the rubric's demonstrated anchor requires an independent (third-party) benchmark. Asserting one would be a claim of independent corroboration, which this scenario never makes, so the criterion is left UNKNOWN. An internal comparison of placement rates would grade only 2 (limited).

What real evidence would be needed

Real, current, investor-visible records for each criterion, at least document-supported, and corroborated or verified for a grade of 4. Company-specific gaps from public research:

- Filed accounts: the UK company's FY2025 accounts were overdue on 2026-10-18; management accounts for 2025 and 2026.
- The legal entity that contracts with Nigerian customers (no CAC registration found) and any NCAA approvals for the simulator.
- Zino's own take (fee or commission) separated from pass-through partner tuition.
- Named airline, operator and government agreements behind placement and programme claims.